

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Draft As Default

Q I do most of my printing at the Draft setting. But it's a bother to have to change it to that every time. Is there a way for the default print setting to be Draft instead of Normal?

Mahesh Wankhede

A This is simple. Just open Printers and Faxes from the Control Panel. Select your default printer and choose "Set printer properties" or something like that. The exact steps will depend on what printer you have, but you need to land at Printing Preferences. Here's where you'll find the box where you always select Draft mode. Select it and click OK twice to close the settings dialog box. Draft is now the default!

Through The Looking Glass

Q The names of the icons on my desktop have a background colour. This destroys the appeal of my wallpaper! How can I get them to be transparent?

Ankit Patel

A There is a sort of hidden setting in XP that controls whether the icon labels on the desktop have a drop-shadow with a transparent background or are text laid out on the system background colour. Here's what you need to do in order to make the icon labels transparent: right-click My Computer and choose Properties. Click the Advanced tab, and click the Settings button in the panel labelled Performance. Click the Visual Effects tab in the Performance dialog. Check the box titled "Use drop shadows for icon labels on the desktop". Click OK twice, and your wallpaper is beautiful again!

Cam-To-DVD?

Q I've been trying to convert analogue video-tapes to digital format, as files on my computer, using my analogue 8mm video camera and a capture device. I'm using MyDVD; the video is fine, but there's no audio. What cable connections and software would I need to get the audio as well? I intend to convert the 8mm tapes to DVDs. Going straight from my camera to DVD would be even better!

Solomon Verghese

A If all you want to do is convert tape to DVD, it's simpler than putting the video onto your PC and then converting. For example, you could use the Sony DVDirect VRDMC1. Plug your

camcorder or VCR directly into DVDirect, which will burn a CD or DVD from the feed, including the audio. The device supports both analogue video and audio connections, as well as FireWire.

Don't Do The Math

Q Does a 64-bit processor require twice as much memory as a 32-bit processor because of the increased word length?

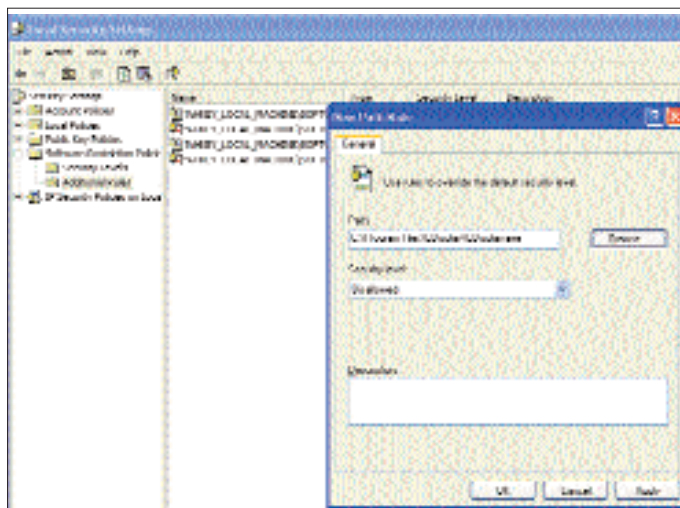
Anirudh Sathe

A No! The amount of memory you can use is limited by the motherboard and/or the memory controller rather than the processor itself. One more thing that affects the amount of memory is the operating system. The 32-bit version of Windows XP can support a maximum of 4 GB of RAM with up to 2 GB of dedicated memory per process, whereas 64-bit operating systems can address up to 128 GB. In case it interests you, the benefits of 64-bit vs. 32-bit, span across all types of memory, including 16 TB of virtual memory vs. 4 GB, 1 TB of cache vs. 1 GB and support for a page file of up to 512 TB vs. 16 TB.

Die A Dodo's Death!

Q I have Windows XP on my computer. A certain program launches itself automatically. I am unable to stop it from running—even if I run the Task Manager and kill the program from there, it starts again all by itself. I can't even delete the .exe file—it re-spawns!

Mayank Rajawat



Set Software Restriction Policy using Secpol.msc

A First, you need to stop the program from launching itself at startup. To do this, go to Start > Run, type "msconfig" and hit [Enter]. Click on the Startup tab, locate the program in the list, and uncheck the box to its left. Also note the path of the program from here. Click OK and restart Windows for the change to take effect.

To prevent the program from launching itself, you have to create a new "software restric-